



QUEER FOLKS: SEXUAL EXPRESSION AND STATUS

NURS 280 JUNE 16, 2026

WHAT IDENTITIES?



2SLGBTQAI+

trans

bisexual

queer

gay

pansexual

lesbian

asexual

two spirit

demisexual

intersex

MSM

questioning

A QUICK HISTORY OF LGBTQ LEGAL STATUS IN CANADA

Prior to 1969: gay men charged/imprisoned for “gross indecency”

1969: Omnibus Bill decriminalizes gay sex for those over the age of 21

1973: “Homosexuality” removed as a disorder from Diagnostic and Statistics Manual of mental disorders

1989: Canadian Human Rights Commissions says same-sex parents and their children are a “family”

1992: Lesbians and gay men can officially serve in the military

1996: protection for sexual orientation added under Canadian Human Rights Act

2005: Same-sex marriage legal (2002 in PQ)

2017: Formal apology from PM for the systemic discrimination and violence faced by queer Canadians

2018: Expungement of Historically Unjust Convictions Act



NOVEMBER 28, 2017 HOC



LAWS GOVERNING PROTECTION

CANADIAN CHARTER OF RIGHTS & FREEDOMS

15. (1) Every individual is equal before and under the law and has the right to the equal protection and equal benefit of the law without discrimination and, in particular, without discrimination based on race, national or ethnic origin, colour, religion, sex, age or mental or physical disability.

CANADIAN CRIMINAL CODE

Hate Propaganda

(advocating genocide or publicly inciting hatred against any identifiable group)

In this section, identifiable group means any section of the public distinguished by colour, race, religion, national or ethnic origin, age, sex, **sexual orientation**, gender identity or expression, or mental or physical disability.

BC HUMAN RIGHTS CODE

Prohibits discrimination based on: "...the race, colour, ancestry, place of origin, religion, marital status, family status, physical or mental disability, sex, **sexual orientation**, gender identity or expression, or age of that person or that group or class of persons."



2SLGBTQIA+ STUDENTS IN BRITISH COLUMBIA

12 EVIDENCE-BASED FACTS

HOW ARE LGBTQ2S+ YOUTH DOING IN BC?

1

There is more than XX and XY. Worldwide, people born with bodies outside of traditional male/ female categories are as common as people with red hair (or twice the estimated population of Canada).



3

Gay and bisexual male students are twice as likely to self-harm. Lesbian and bisexual female students are two to three times more likely to self-harm.



5

Schools are identified by 2SLGBTQIA+ youth as potential safe havens.

7

Providing gender-neutral bathrooms to all students helps 2SLGBTQIA+ youth feel safer at schools.



9

Schools with established GSAs and anti-homophobic bullying policies have lower odds of discrimination, suicidal thoughts, and attempts among LGB and heterosexual students.



11

Screening the Out in Schools LGBTQ film program reduces social exclusion and teasing among heterosexual and lesbian/ bisexual female students.



2

75% of surveyed Canadian transgender youth reported self-harming in the past year, nearly 50% experienced extreme stress in the past 30 days, and a third had attempted suicide in the past year.



4

Half of transgender students in BC (ages 14-18) reported being bullied at school, 65% were taunted or ridiculed and 44% were physically threatened or injured in the past year.



6

Gay and bisexual male students in BC are less likely to participate in sports without a coach (65% and 51%, respectively).

8

Transgender students in BC who reported feeling connected to their schools were twice as likely as those who did not to report good or excellent mental health.



10

A school GSA costs about an hour per week to sponsor a teacher or public health nurse during the school year (about \$1,000). This can save \$183,000 in healthcare costs.



12

Displaying 2SLGBTQIA+ friendly symbols helps improve 2SLGBTQIA+ youths' self-esteem and fosters a sense of belonging.

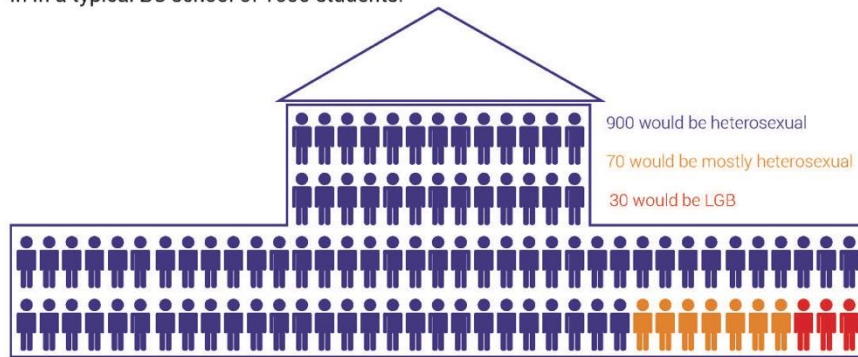


Supporting LGBTQ Youth



Research suggests that a GSA (Gay-Straight Alliance or Gender-Sexuality Alliance) intervention in secondary schools could have positive impacts on the youth attending. A team from McCreary and SARAVYC systematically reviewed and analysed research on GSA interventions and applied the results to a 'typical' BC secondary school of 1,000 students.

In in a typical BC school of 1000 students:



Having a GSA in place for more than three years, as opposed to having no GSA, could reduce:

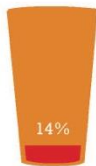


7 LGBTQ students' suicidal ideation

Fewer youth reporting problem substance use:



Fewer youth reporting binge drinking:



2 LGB girls' and 5 heterosexual boys' suicide attempts



What does it cost? What does it save?



Cost of GSA

Potential savings in health care system

The cost of implementing a GSA is about an hour's time per week for a sponsor teacher or public health nurse during the school year, but could potentially save the health care system substantial amounts.

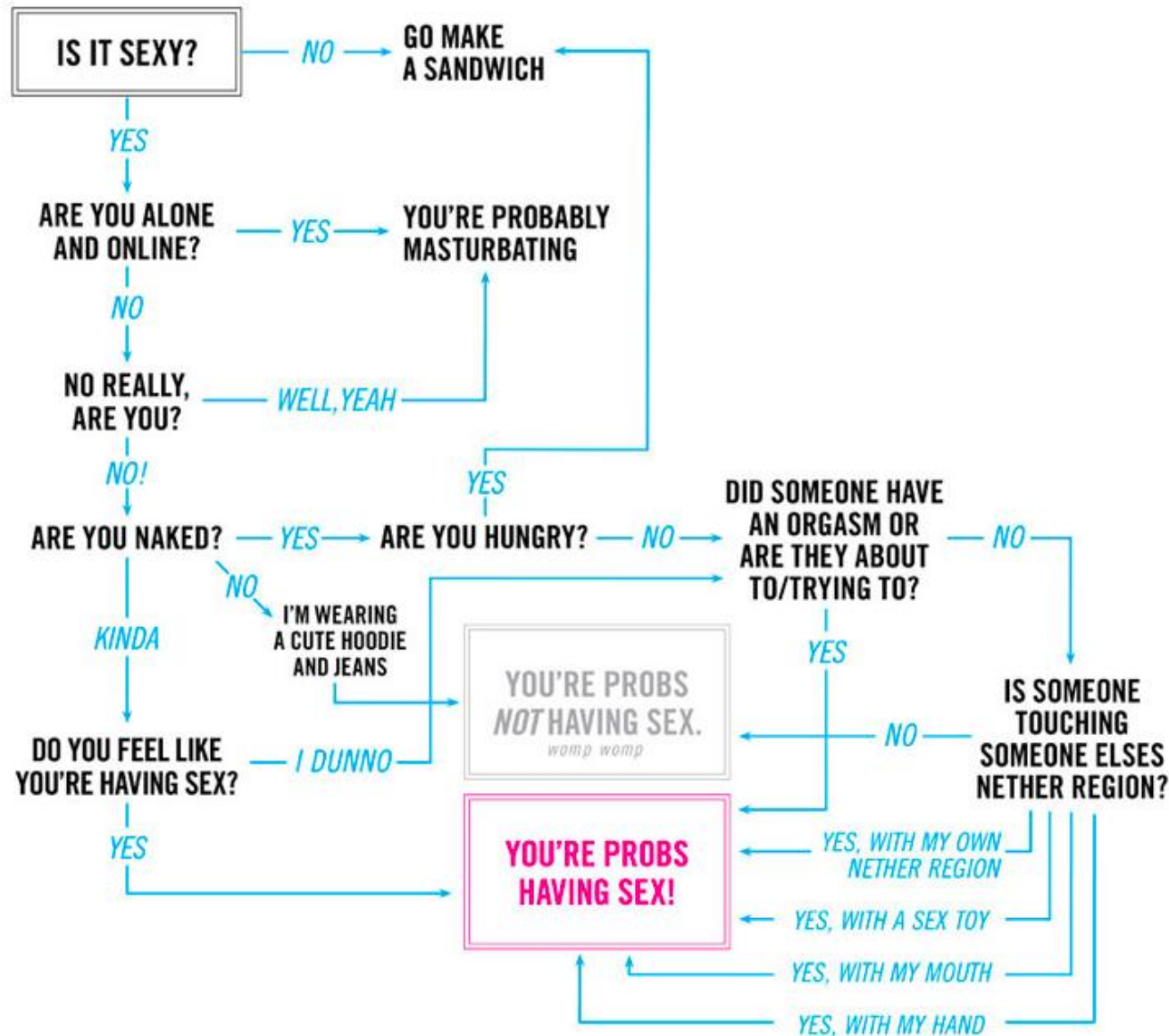
To see more information about how GSAs or other intervention methods can help in schools, please read our full report, School-based interventions to reduce health disparities among LGBTQ youth: Considering the evidence.

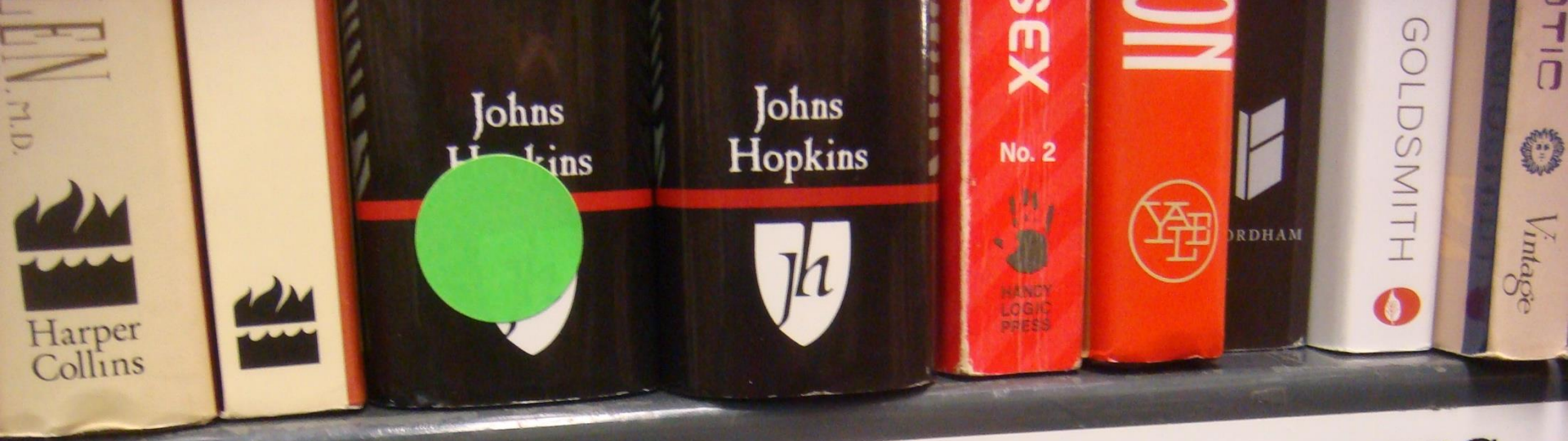
View the full report and download the factsheet at:
www.mcs.bc.ca
www.saravyc.ubc.ca

HOW DO QUEER FOLKS HAVE SEX?!



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SEXUALITY CONTINUES



THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

